

You.com is an artificial intelligence and search engine startup company.

The company was founded in 2020 by Richard Socher, the former chief scientist at Salesforce, and Bryan McCann, a former NLP researcher at Salesforce.

History

The domain You.com was initially purchased in 1996 by Benioff, and the company founded in 2020. You.com opened its public beta on November 9, 2021, funded in part by Salesforce founder and CEO Marc Benioff.

In July 2022, You.com received Series A funding round led by Radical Ventures with participation from Time Ventures, Breyer Capital, Norwest Venture Partners and Day One Ventures. In September 2024, You.com received Series B funding led by Georgian. In September 2025, You.com raised \$100 million in Series C funding led by Cox Enterprises at a \$1.5 billion valuation, achieving unicorn status.

In 2023, You.com pivoted from its consumer focused search engine products to artificial intelligence tools. Around January 2023, the company was incorporating AI chats into its search engine.

Products

On December 23, 2022, You.com was the first search engine to launch an LLM chatbot with live web results alongside its responses. Initially known as YouChat, the chatbot was primarily based on the GPT-3.5 large language model and could answer questions, suggest ideas, translate text, summarize articles, compose emails, and write code snippets, while staying up-to-date with current events and citing sources. Several further versions of YouChat were released. The second version, called YouChat 2.0, was released on February 7, 2023, incorporated improved conversational AI and community-built applications by blending a large language model named C-A-L (Chat, Apps, and Links). This update enabled YouChat to

provide results in various formats, such as charts, photos, videos, tables, graphs, text or code, so users can find answers without leaving the search results page. YouChat 3.0, unveiled on May 4, 2023, combined chat functionality with results from Reddit, TikTok, Stack Overflow and Wikipedia.

YouPro

On June 21, 2023, You.com introduced YouPro, a paid subscription. Both free and paid versions provide access to large language models connected to the internet with citation capabilities.

ARI

In February 2025, You.com launched ARI (Advanced Research and Insights), a deep research agent that scans over 400 sources simultaneously to produce research reports with verified citations and interactive graphs, charts, and visualizations. The platform targets regulated industries where comprehensive source verification is critical, with customers including healthcare publishers and advisory firms.

Reception

You.com was named one of TIME's Best Inventions of 2022.

You.com's ARI (Advanced Research & Insights) feature was named one of TIME's Best Inventions of 2025.

References

External links

Official website